'Angadi' in their period. Day market was called as Nalangadi while the night market was called as Allangadi according to Saint Poet Ilango in Silapathigaram, Madurai–Kanchi. He described Madurai as iruperu neyamath meaning sleepless city due to round the clock business activities.

Coastal Trade in Ancient Tamil Nadu

Big cities like Poompuhar had the 'Maruvurappakam' (inland town) and 'Pattinapakkam' (coastal Town), had market and bazaars where many merchants met one another for the purpose of selling or buying different kinds of commodities and food stuff. Port towns like Tondi, Korkai, Puhar and Muziri were always seen as busy with marts and markets with activities related to imports and exports. In such a brisk trade, people of the coastal region, engaged themselves in coastal trade and developed their intercontinental trade contacts. They were engaged in different kinds of fishing pearls, and conches and produced salts and built ships. Boats like 'Padagu', 'Thimil', 'Thoni', 'Ambu' 'Odampunai' etc… were used to cross rivers for domestic trade while Kalam, Marakalam, Vangam, Navai etc.. were used for crossing oceans for foreign trade.

Important Ancient Trade Centres in Tamilnadu

i. Alagankulam (Ramanathapuram)
ii. Mylarphan (Mylapore, near Chennai),
iii. Keberis (Kaveripumpattinam),
iv. Poduke or Poduce (Arikamedu, Puducherry),
v. Soptana (Marakanam),
vi. Nikam (Nagapattinam),
vii. Periyapattinam,
viii. Kayalpattinam,
ix. Colchi (Korkai)
x. Comari (Kanyakumari)

Role of the Government during Ancient Tamil Nadu

Foreigners who transacted business were known as Yavanars. Arabs who traded with Tamil were called 'Jonagar'. Pattinappalai praised Kaveripumpattinam as a city where various foreigners of high civilization speaking different languages assembled to transact business with the support of the then Kingdom.

The role of the State in trade related to two aspects namely adequate infrastructure to sustain the trade and administrative machinery for taxation. During the Sangam period, the main trade routes were passing through thick forests over western ghats. The State protected the merchant caravans on these trade routes from robbers and wild

ALAMBARAI



Location: Situated 20 kms south east of Maduranthakam in Kanchipuram District.

Significance: It was once a flourishing place of commerce. A mint also existed.

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